Bedtime Story

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Welcome!

COL-309801

Countryside, Texas

???: Thank you so much! I've been trying and trying, but no one was willing to give me a ride.

???: I met another lady just now, but she seemed to be in a hurry, or maybe she was just wary of taking a stranger. Either way, it's understandable.

???: She called me "Miss Sheep," but even a sheep could be dangerous on a long, desolate road like this.

The little sheep follows close behind her companion, like a cloud skirting along the ground.

Barbara: Ms. Tuesday. That's your name, right?

Barbara: Are you familiar with the area? I have a question about this path we're walking.

Tuesday slows down to come side by side with Barbara.

Tuesday: I surely am, missy.

Tuesday: It's a shortcut to the motel. Most prefer to follow the highway.

Tuesday: I don't blame them for sticking to the main road. The rumors around Route 77 couldn't be more terrifying—eerie sounds, sudden fog ... Who knows what could happen on a muddy trail like this?

Barbara: Oh, that strange sound! I heard it on my way here. That's what scared off my driver.

Tuesday: That explains why a child like you was standing by the road all alone. How cruel-hearted your driver is!

Tuesday: It's dangerous out here. Even a local like me wouldn't wander the roads alone at night.

The baby in her arms pushes against its swaddle. She quickly tucks it back in.

Tuesday's cheeks flush red, perhaps from the effort of carrying the child in the Texas heat.

Barbara: Oh, miss. I'd be more than happy to hold the baby for a while. If you'd trust me to, that is.

Tuesday: Oh, don't you worry, dear. The little one just fell asleep. It'll make a fuss if we accidentally wake it up.

Tuesday: And shouldn't you be worried about whether YOU can trust ME?

Barbara: Sorry?

Tuesday: There you are on a deserted road, and up comes a friendly stranger who offers a place for you to stay the night.

Tuesday: I claimed to be a motel maid who just happened to be passing by, but why would a maid have a baby in her arms?

Tuesday: You've come all this way with me, missy, and now you're worried if I can trust you?

Tuesday: Have you heard this baby in my arms make a single sound? I could be cradling a butcher's knife, a monster, or the skull of that terrified driver, his eyes still wide with fear.

Tuesday draws nearer, looking Barbara in the eye. The little sheep dares not look away. Her nose gives an involuntary twitch of fear.

Tuesday: **Oh, look!**

She raises her arm and sweeps Barbara's shoulder.

Barbara: ...!

Tuesday: Oopsie daisy.

A gunshot echoes, and a flock of birds takes wing. Barbara's heart is pounding.

Tuesday: There's dirt on your clothes. Oh, and they're such nice clothes, too. I'll clean them up for you when we get to the motel.

She shakes her head apologetically.

Barbara: Thank you.

Tuesday: Heh, I should be thanking YOU, dear. So many of my guests are running from the law or smuggling something—you're like a rose among thorns.

Tuesday: I was just making a little joke, is all. I didn't mean to scare you.

Tuesday: In fact, I went to the roadside to wait for a customer, but they never came. And my baby's been fussy lately—won't sleep unless I hold it in my arms. So I took it along with me.

Tuesday: Anyway, we're almost there. But do be careful outside alone in the future, won't you?

Tuesday: This way, please.

Entrance, Tuesday's Motel

Barbara: Oh, it's beautiful.

Tuesday: I'm glad you like it. I've put a lot of effort into running this place.

Her face is pale with fatigue, but she still manages a grin.

Tuesday: You see that sign?

Barbara narrows her eyes as she tries to read it.

Barbara: "Tues—day's—MOTEL"?

Tuesday: Yes. My mama used to run it. I took over after she fell sick.

Tuesday pushes the door open as she speaks.

Front Desk, Tuesday's Motel

Tuesday: Welcome.

Tuesday: Are there any requirements for your room? I'm sure I can find one to suit your needs.

Barbara: Well, a quiet room with a little sunshine and a table for me to write at would be more than enough.

Tuesday: Ah, I've got just the room for you.

Tuesday: Could you wait here a moment? I just need to set down the baby and go check on the room. Then I'll come check you in, alright?

Barbara: Sure, I'll just take a look around here, if that's okay?

Tuesday: Of course, make yourself comfortable.

Tuesday strides away with swift, soft steps.

Barbara, now alone, unclips her notebook from her chest.

The notebook is in the shape of a heart, with a scarlet cover and white paper inside.

It's a unique and delicate design.

Barbara: No, not this page.

Barbara: Not here, either.

Barbara: Bonnette definitely told me about her parents and their restaurant. It should be around ...

Barbara: When was it we talked about that? The last time I saw her?

Barbara: Maybe near the back? Hm, but I haven't written much here.

???: Hi? Hello?

Barbara: Oh, hello!

Barbara jumps at this sudden greeting, her heartbeat quickening.

She nervously clips her notebook back onto her chest and takes a deep, calming breath.

Young Guest: Whoa!

Barbara: ...

This isn't the first time she's received a reaction like this. In fact, this one is rather tame.

Barbara: There's no need to be scared. I'm not an illusion or some kind of monster. It usually takes people a moment or two to get used to the way I look.

Young Guest: Oh my! You must be one of those arcanists! And not just any old one, either—the most special kind! If only the sheep on my farm could talk and walk like you!

Young Guest: You just check in today? Anything I can help you with?

Young Guest: Ah, but I've got some jobs to do first. I'll catch up with you later, alright? Oh, I'm Kayla, by the way.

Barbara: You can call me Barbara.

Kayla: Pleasure to meet you, Ms. Barbara!

With a basket under her arm, Kayla walks briskly out of the motel.

Barbara: ...

Barbara: This place must be nice to have such energetic guests.

Tuesday: We always provide the best service, despite the limited conditions.

Barbara doesn't jump this time.

She's becoming used to the sudden appearances of new figures.

Barbara: Thank you very much, Ms. Tuesday. You walk really quietly.

Tuesday: All part of the service I provide. You wouldn't want me stomping around the halls at night now, would you? Anyway, your room's ready. Please follow me.

Tuesday: You must be tired coming in so late. Why don't you drop off your bags and take a rest? You can check in later. I trust you won't jump out the window to avoid paying me, right?

Barbara: Actually, based on my past interviews, it's more common for a guest to kill the owner, take anything of value from the place, and leave behind a messy, empty building.

Barbara: Then the ghost of the owner haunts the motel, waiting for future guests to check in so they can tear them apart. At least, that's how the stories go.

Tuesday: Hahaha!

Tuesday: Well, now, aren't you a hoot? Talking of ghost stories in such a serious manner!

Barbara: I'm sorry. I didn't mean to frighten you. I was just retelling the stories I'd recorded. That's the job of an editor, you see.

Tuesday: Don't you worry, missy. I love these kinds of stories.

Tuesday: What would life be without a few ghost stories to keep things interesting?

Tuesday: Your room's just at the end of the hallway. We provide one free meal of a sandwich and hot milk per day.

Tuesday: This is the room. The door's unlocked. Go ahead and open it.

Barbara steps forward and reaches for the door handle.

It's a door like any other. It's painted a simple color and a little worn and rotting at the edges.

Tuesday suddenly leans forward, staring at the wall between Barbara's door and the previous one.

Tuesday: **What's going on?!**

Barbara: What is that ... Bonnette?!

She turns to Tuesday, not realizing in her panic that she has blurted out the name "Bonnette."

How did they not notice it before?

Right there, before Tuesday, stands a crimson door.

Barbara moves closer to Tuesday, reaching to pull her away from it.

Barbara: Stay away from that door. Whatever's behind it doesn't seem friendly.

Barbara: Wait—

The door creaks open.

Tuesday puts her hand on Barbara's back. Barbara can't tell if she's trying to support her or push her in.

Tuesday: Child, be—

Barbara: What?

Velvet Heart

COL-309802

Red Room, Tuesday's Motel

Barbara: Ugh! Did I ... trip?

Barbara: Not bleeding.

Barbara: Ms. Tuesday ...?

Tuesday: ...

Barbara: Good, she's still breathing.

Barbara: Doctors do say that people can faint from sudden shock.

She cautiously checks Tuesday's condition, then stands up to look around the room.

Fabric clings to the walls and ceiling, and envelops the furniture like skin. The entire room is a rich, fleshy red.

All except a small white crib in the center.

It sits there like a bone jutting out from bloody flesh.

Barbara: Is someone hiding in here?

She clenches the Walkman in her hand. The feeling of its edges digging into her palm helps her calm down.

Barbara: No, not yet. If my Walkman runs out of batteries now, I'll be in real trouble.

Barbara: Is there anything ...

The rumbling sound seems to have been completely absorbed by the room. Now, all she can hear is her nervous breathing and the heartbeat in her chest.

Barbara squats down, attempting to find something useful.

Just as she's about to give up, a tickle on her shoulder draws her attention.

Barbara: ...?

It's a spider. It crawls out from under her sleeve and comes to stop on her palm.

Barbara: Oh, hello, little guy! I didn't know I'd find you here, too! Well, this makes things much easier. Could you do me a favor and have a look over there?

Barbara: Move lightly, okay? We don't want to get spotted.

She holds her breath as she waits for the spider to reach the crib.

It climbs up the crib and disappears into the fabric.

...

Tuesday: Oh. Seems our missy has a little secret.

Barbara is so focused on the spider that she doesn't notice that Tuesday has opened her eyes.

Tuesday: Hmm. The classic story of the "ghost mother" should be horrifying enough.

Barbara: ...

Barbara: Could it be that?

The spider hangs down at the edge of the crib, swinging from its web. Neither one notices that Tuesday has closed her eyes again.

Barbara: I see. Guess this place is safe for now.

The spider crawls into the corner of the room. Barbara makes to follow it.

Tuesday: No.

Barbara: You're awake! Do you know that ...

Tuesday: Mama, please.

Barbara: Mama? Did you know that this motel used to be a restaurant?

Barbara: *sigh*

Barbara sits down next to Tuesday and gently tucks her hair behind her ear.

Tuesday murmurs, seemingly sound asleep. Her face looks almost serene, even in the eerie scarlet room.

Tuesday: Not so fast.

Bonnette: Not so fast; you'll get dirt on your clothes!

Barbara: We're in a hurry. A little dirt is the least of our worries.

Barbara: As soon as this interview's over, we need to follow the wind to a safe place.

Barbara: I wish UTTU would find a stable shelter so we didn't have to change locations all the time. I always hear people moaning about losing precious documents during the move.

Bonnette: Haha! At least they didn't lose themselves.

Bonnette: I was hoping to take you to my parent's restaurant, since it's so rare that we're here in Texas. But since we're in a rush, we can go next time. Although, will there be a next time?

Barbara: ...

Bonnette: What's wrong? It's nothing special, just a regular family restaurant.

Bonnette: Don't tell me you've got caught up in those fancy places the UTTU folks always go to?

Barbara: You know I'm not.

Barbara tilts her head as she tries to capture every detail in the wind.

Barbara: It'll take another half-day for the wind's trajectory to become clear. Is that enough time for us to have a meal?

Bonnette: Ah ...

Bonnette: It's still a little rushed. I'll make sure we have enough time to enjoy a dinner together next time.

Barbara: I lost you to a place where the wind can't go.

Barbara: Until today.

Tuesday: ...

Research has shown that the companionship of animals with soft fur and a mild temper can help soothe emotions.

The current situation further proves this statement. In the company of the little lamb, Tuesday's breathing gradually slows down.

Barbara: Are you reliving lost memories in your dreams? Or is it just a coincidence?

Barbara: Are you still you?

She reaches out to Tuesday.

Sheep are often considered the symbol of good sleep. They can lull people to slumber and bring them good dreams.

But Barbara can do more than just this. 1 ... 2 ... 3 ... like sheep jumping over a fence, she can leap into a person's dreams.

She and her sheep mother used to frolic together in each other's dreams. You see, this power runs in her blood.

She used this power to learn more about her human mother and won herself a job as an UTTU editor.

And now, she's using it to find her long-lost friend.

[English text unavailable]

COL-309803

Barbara: Still in the motel.

Barbara: Hm. This place must mean a lot to her.

Barbara: But ...

She stops at the figure before her. It takes a few seconds for her to recognize its face.

Barbara: It's Tuesday. She's slumped on the floor, cold and breathless. Her life has been taken by an inexplicable being. A typical horror story scene.

Barbara: Judging from the direction she's facing, she was trying to leave the room to get help. Clearly, she failed.

Every door in the hallway is tightly shut, and they all look exactly the same.

There is no sign of the crimson velvet door.

[English text unavailable]
COL-309804

Barbara: This is the washroom. There are ghosts in the mirrors and weeping shadows lurking in the corners. When you turn on the tap, blood pours out.

Barbara: A classic crime scene. The washroom is the most common place for motel victims to be killed.

Barbara: Maybe she came here to fix her uniform? Or she was checking on a guest's complaint?

Barbara: Either way, it didn't end well.

She carefully steps over the body on the ground and returns to the hallway.

Time to go to the motel entrance. Horror stories always start the moment you step into the place.

On her way down the stairs, she hears the sound of a door closing. It's quiet, but her ears are sensitive.

She makes her way to the source of the sound.

[English text unavailable]
COL-309805

Barbara: This is the door.

Barbara: Hello, anyone in there?

No answer. She peers through the keyhole. Empty. There doesn't seem to be any place that someone could hide, either.

Unless they're just out of her sight—pressed low against the door—nothing but a thin piece of wood between them.

Barbara: ...

She changes her angle, getting on tiptoes to try and gain a better view of the room.

Barbara: ...!

Barbara: There's one in here, too.

She stumbles backward, and her eyes fall upon the shadowy stairwell to her right. The steps disappear into total darkness. Barbara shudders.

Will Tuesday be waiting in the shadows? Or at the front desk?

What's hiding in the silent darkness?

Barbara: It's just a dream.

[English text unavailable]
COL-309806

Barbara: I've never known anyone to dream so calmly about their own death.

Barbara: No one knows what happens after we die. People are as terrified of death ...

Barbara: ... as they are intrigued by it.

Once again, she's greeted with Tuesday's cold and lifeless body. How many times have they met this way? She can't remember.

Barbara steps closer and closer to the body, as if allured by it. But before she can reach out to touch her, she's interrupted.

Barbara: Is that singing?

Lullaby

COL-309807

Tuesday: "Rock a bye baby on the tree top, when the wind blows the cradle will rock."

Tuesday: "When the bough breaks the cradle will fall and down will come baby cradle and all."

Tuesday: Oh, you're awake, my sweet child.

Tuesday: I'm terribly sorry about all this. Are you alright?

Barbara: *cough* I—I'm ok.

She struggles to sit up from Tuesday's lap. Realizing her headphones are no longer in her ears, she hastily puts them back in.

Only when the familiar country music plays does the itch in her throat begin to soothe.

Barbara: When did you wake up? What happened in this room?

Barbara: Do you know a girl named Bonnette?

Tuesday: My, my. You're like a little question machine up and running again.

Tuesday: Bonnette. A very sweet name, but it doesn't ring a bell.

Tuesday: As for the room—what could happen in such a safe and quiet place? You can go ahead and rest here until you're fully recovered.

Tuesday: Although I must apologize. There's no desk here. After all, we're just a small motel in the country. Our facilities are rather limited.

Barbara: And I need to apologize for the coming accusation—what you're doing to me now is called false imprisonment.

Tuesday: Ouch. I took good care of you when you passed out and made sure you had sweet dreams. How could you accuse me of something like that?

Tuesday lowers her head to fix the hem of her skirt. It seems to be a habitual action.

Barbara: That was a nightmare, not a dream.

Tuesday: All the more reason to get some proper rest, don't you think?

Tuesday: In fact, I envy children like you. I never dream, you see.

Barbara: But, wasn't that your dream?

Tuesday doesn't answer her muttered words.

Tuesday: Well, I enjoyed our little chat, but I've got work to do.

Tuesday: I should get back to the highway to greet that guest—ah, and I'd better buy some groceries while I'm out, too.

Tuesday: Got to make sure I have enough food for your meal later, don't I, little one?

Barbara: Please, wait. I have one last question.

She points at the crib in the center of the room.

Barbara: This room doesn't seem like a nursery at all. The crib's empty, and you're not carrying that "baby" in your arms right now. So ...

Barbara: So there really isn't a baby in your arms. What is it then? A corpse? Or a ghost?

Barbara: When I first arrived, someone mentioned a disappearance here.

Barbara: There are too many weird things happening here: your "baby," missing guests, bizarre rooms ...

She wants to ask what's next.

Tuesday: ...

Tuesday: You're a sharp one. I like you. Most people are afraid to even ask, you see.

Her cheeks flush again. Somehow, it doesn't bring any sense of vigor or health to her face; instead, it adds a fragile tone to her pale skin.

She looks like a silver table knife that could bend at any time.

Tuesday: Ah, you've broken my heart.

Tuesday: But, I'll answer your question. You can't just punish your children every time they make a mistake.

Tuesday: Because one day they'll get used to it, and it won't frighten them anymore.

Tuesday: The truth is, the baby in the swaddling cloth is my youngest and most beloved child. It doesn't want to see you—gets jealous, you see.

Tuesday: That's why it's best to separate you two.

As she says this, she makes her way to the door and closes it with a gentle click.

Barbara: I suppose that answer will have to do.

Barbara: Well, interviews rarely go as planned now, do they?

She checks around the room, trying to find her spider friend.

She squints as she tries to spot the little thing. The good news is, she has plenty of time to search.

The bad news is, her friend seems to be gone.

Barbara: Alright, why don't I review the information I have so far?

Barbara: Are Tuesday and Bonnette the same person?

Barbara: The current answer seems to be "no."

Barbara: But I still have some reservations.

Barbara: Next, the secret of this motel.

She turns to the next page.

Barbara: My arcane skill only takes effect when I touch someone who's dreaming.

Barbara: When I entered that dream, I had one hand on Tuesday, and the other on the floor.

Barbara: And she just said she never dreams. So ...

Tuesday: Ah, my sweet child. Have you figured it out?

Barbara: Then, maybe it was the dream of a ghost?

Barbara: The ghost of someone who died in this motel?

Tuesday: *sigh*

She sighs in disappointment and steps away from the keyhole.

Tuesday: Silly child.

As if agreeing with her, the other doors in the hallway open and close synchronously.

Tuesday: Quiet now. We have guests.

The door beside her opens and spits out a spider.

Tuesday: Leave them. She could use a few spiders to keep her company.

Tuesday: You've done well, little one. You can come with me.

She disappears into the dark hallway.

Silent Night

COL-309808

Tuesday: So, our sweet, silly little sheep girl still couldn't figure out what was going on.

Tuesday: It's far more interesting than a simple motel murder.

Tuesday: The truth is ... well ...

Tuesday: This is how the story started.

[English text unavailable]

COL-309809

???: Hello? Is anyone there?

???: I heard you're looking for a new maid.

No reply. The girl walks to the front desk.

A blank application form is lying on it.

???: Name ... This should do.

Tuesday: Tuesday, Tuesday. Sounds like a criminal alias, but more friendly.

Tuesday: The name of the girl who ran away from home and broke into a haunted motel.

Tuesday: Haha!

[English text unavailable]

COL-309810

Tuesday: Excuse me? Can anyone help me?

Tuesday: I'm hungry and tired.

Tuesday: Hello? I'm here for the job. I've filled out the form downstairs.

There is no sound but the echo of her own voice.

She knocks on every door, but not a single one opens.

Tuesday: Boring.

Tuesday: Hm?

A small noise grabs her attention. She looks around.

Not in shock or surprise, but in a kind of curious glee.

Standing in front of the source of the sound, she bends over to look through the keyhole.

???: ...!

Screams pour out of the doorways and into the hallway. They quickly merge into one solid sound, rattling her eardrums.

Tuesday: Oh, do you need something? How can I help you?

Tuesday: My apologies for the noise. I didn't mean to inconvenience you.

[English text unavailable]

COL-309811

She stops.

Tuesday: Oh, how generous! There's a room for me already.

A door has appeared beside her, red as a fresh cut.

She opens it.

Tuesday: What a beautiful place. It's like I'm in a beating heart.

Tuesday: Too bad I can't feel your rhythm in my hand. But I can touch you.

Tuesday: Huh. Is it me who's trembling? Or you?

She caresses the floor, occasionally pulling and twisting the fabric in her amusement.

Tuesday: The stories of the disappearances have spread pretty far. Some say there's a gang around these parts. Others say a bear or some other wild animal.

Tuesday: I even heard stories about a killer clown and a murderer in a bunny suit.

Tuesday: No one dares go out at night anymore, especially young lovers. Doesn't matter how beautiful the moon is.

Tuesday: And despite all these stories, no one has ever stopped to think that the motel itself could be the culprit.

Tuesday: Is it because the thought has never even come to their minds, or that it seemed too ridiculous to be possible?

She stands up, releasing the fabric from her palm.

Tuesday: The answer is simple: They're afraid—just like you're afraid of me right now.

Tuesday: I know exactly what your fear is. You're like a child holding his breath in his room and staring wide-eyed into the darkness.

Tuesday: He's staring at the crack beneath the door. The light from the hallway always shone there. But now, it's gone. Dark.

Tuesday: What's blocking it? Who's out there?

The wall and floor press tightly against one another, producing a sound akin to grinding teeth.

Tuesday: Daddy? Mama? Is that you, older brother? Are you here to kiss me goodnight?

Tuesday: The door stays silent, and the crack stays dark.

Tuesday: His mind races as he tries to make sense of what's happening.

Tuesday: Maybe it's a rat? Or a kitty cat that hopped in through the hallway window?

Bang! A window slams closed in the distance.

Tuesday: Finally, the light returns beneath the doorway.

Tuesday: And in the dim light, he realizes he made a mistake.

Tuesday: *Whatever it is,*
it isn't outside the door.
It's in his room.

Gusts of wind surround her in a fearful, painful howl.

Tuesday: Yes, fear often comes from the loss of control—from the unknown.

Tuesday: Poor child, facing all that with nothing but a blanket to defend himself.

Tuesday: He spent that night with eyes wide open. But once the morning light came, there was nothing but an empty coat lying in front of the door.

She hears footsteps coming toward her.

Tuesday: But that coat wasn't his. Nor was it any of his family's. Who left the coat on his bedroom floor?

Tuesday: He still wonders to this day.

Tuesday: Heh heh, intriguing.

Tuesday: I can tell that you're still a child yourself, needing care and companionship.

Tuesday: Maybe you could use a maid to tell you bedtime stories and a friend to spread fear for you. What do you say?

A cool, soft touch climbs up her pinky finger.

Tuesday: With a few tweaks, the story could be quite different.

Tuesday: The child comes home late, enters his room, and before he can turn on the light, feels two eyes staring at him through the darkness.

Tuesday: Both are terrified. Neither one dares look away. Their two worlds have somehow collided.

She recognizes what's gripping her pinky finger as a child's hand.

Tuesday: Until the boy finally plucks up the courage to reach for the switch.

Tuesday: Holding his breath, he pushes down to see ...

Tuesday: *HIS EXACT FACE.*

Tuesday: *See? This time the fear comes from the known—the doubt of oneself—*
or at least something disguised as "oneself."

The little hand lets go of her pinky. She hears the footsteps hurry away and disappear into the other side of the room.

Tuesday: You still can't trust me. But that's very sensible.

Tuesday: You shouldn't easily trust someone, especially when they're too similar to you.

Tuesday: But I'll stay here and tell you everything I've learned from the outside world.

She spins one story after another, like a patient mother soothing a naughty child.

A knock on the door interrupts her.

Tuesday: Oh, who could that be?

She opens the door.

???: So long.

Tuesday: Can I help you?

The gaunt lady in front of her doesn't answer. Instead, she starts to unbutton the maid uniform she's wearing.

Soon, the dress is off. She neatly folds it and puts it down next to the door.

Without a word, she turns around and leaves.

Tuesday: Well, well, well ...

The windows of the entire motel creak open and closed, and the sound of rustling and scratching emanates from within its walls.

She realizes this is an expression of its joy.

Tuesday: Thank you kindly. I'll take over from here.

Tuesday bows deeply to the now former motel maid and picks up the uniform she left.

From now on, she will be the maid of the motel and the owner of a house that feeds on fear.

Tuesday: Does the story end there?

Tuesday: Oh, no. After all, this motel is far older than I am; it has its own wisdom.

Tuesday: It approved of me, but it didn't fully trust me yet.

Tuesday: Be patient, dear. The time will come.

Tuesday: Lucky for you, the time is now. Look.

Tuesday: Sir, did you call?

Tuesday: It's the motel maid. Please open the door.

Tuesday: Sir?

No response.

She puts her hand on her chest. Her heart is beating faster than usual.

She's always been good at peering through keyholes. She's done this since she was a child.

The weight of her body makes the door groan and creak. There's a faint scraping sound coming from behind it.

Tuesday: ...

Tuesday: Oh.

She's also used to the sight of a dead person's eyes.

Tuesday: Another poor guest.

[English text unavailable]

COL-309812

Tuesday: [English text unavailable]

Tuesday: [English text unavailable]

Tuesday: [English text unavailable]

[English text unavailable]

Tuesday: [English text unavailable]

Tuesday: [English text unavailable]

Tuesday: [English text unavailable]

[English text unavailable]

[English text unavailable]

COL-309813

Tuesday: [English text unavailable]

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COL-309815

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A Strange Guest

COL-309816

Tuesday: How many times have I told you not to eat things off the floor?

Tuesday: Several guests have asked me where Mr. Jaden's gone. It's getting difficult to come up with excuses.

Tuesday: You promised to let some guests leave here alive so that the stories about us would go further, remember?

Tuesday: But now, between you eating them and those cultists sacrificing the rest ...

Tuesday: Soon, we won't have any guests left.

The wall shakes in dissatisfaction.

Tuesday: This is not open for discussion.

Tuesday: No more eating dead guests. You hear me?

Tuesday: Don't get involved with the guests problems. Let them figure things out themselves.

The sound of hurried footsteps echoes in the wall, disappearing into the distance.

Tuesday leaves the room in silence.

Tuesday: We had our quarrels, but that was a long time ago.

Tuesday: How did we solve the issue? Let me think.

Tuesday: I suppose there was a little conflict.

Guest: ...

Guest: Ms. Tuesday.

Tuesday: Do be careful, ladies. The blood will be impossible to remove once it seeps through the carpet and soaks into the floorboards.

Tuesday: But don't worry yourselves. I'm the maid. It's my job to clean these kinds of things.

Tuesday: Sorry, I suppose I'm feeling chatty today. My apologies for bothering you.

Guest: Actually, I wanted to thank you, for cleaning up after us and for giving us a place to stay.

Tuesday steps over the body lying on the ground, as if it were a fallen branch rather than a dead person.

She sees the fleeting look of fear in the woman's face and smiles. This is her first reward of the day.

But something else catches her eye.

Tuesday: ...!

Tuesday: What's this?

Tuesday: Is that me? Is this a vision of my future?

The figure slouched against the doorframe is indeed her. The puddle of blood beneath her has painted the floor a dark red.

There's a knife sticking out of her chest. She reaches for the wound. It's soft and warm beneath her fingers.

Tuesday: Interesting. Who would use a butter knife to kill someone? It can barely cut a slice of bread.

A faint voice comes from behind her.

Guest: M-Ms. Tuesday.

Tuesday: Yes? Is there anything else you need? You're shaking—I can tell by your voice.

Entranced by the sight of her own dead body, she answers without turning back.

Guest: Th-That smile ... I've seen it before.

Guest: Is that you? Christine from the farm?

Tuesday turns around to meet the woman's eyes. She ignores the knife clutched in her shaking hand.

Tuesday: Aw, you remember that girl?

Guest: O-Of course I do! She scared the crap out of Tonks. He still won't go into the forest alone.

Guest: Ever since that day, he's talked about the eyes in the forest, that if he went in, his eyes would be pulled out and hung in the branches.

Guest: And Jacob still thinks there's a ghost in his attic, too.

Tuesday: I'm sorry to hear that.

Tuesday: She never wanted to ruin anyone's life.

Guest: I-I know! I know!

She takes a step forward.

Guest: It was her life that was ruined! She could've gotten married, lived in a cabin near the farm, and visited her parents any time she'd liked.

Guest: They never should've let those two fugitives escape. Those monsters even shot the kids. Blood drenched the couch.

Guest: No one ever saw Christine again. There were all kinds of rumors, that she was killed and dragged off somewhere, or that she ran away and starved in the fields, or even that she led the fugitives there herself.

Guest: But I guess you came here, huh? I-I understand, given what happened.

Tuesday: Is that all you wanted to say?

She maintains a polite smile.

Tuesday: Do I know you?

Tuesday: This is a small town, so stories travel fast.

Tuesday: But how do you know it so well? Could you elaborate a little? About the blood-soaked couch, the cup of coffee on the table that was so turbid that it was almost unrecognizable, and the broken nails dug into the floorboards.

Tuesday: Where did you see all these? I saw it through the slit in the lock.

Tuesday: It was terrifying. I couldn't help but imagine if I were the victim.

Her cheeks flush red.

Guest: Y-You don't remember me? We were friends. We lived in the same town. I-I was there when you told us the story about the eyes in the forest.

Her voice shakes, together with the knife she's holding.

Guest: We played together, had fun together. You were the bravest of us all.

Guest: What are you doing here? Trying to avenge your family or something? Look.

Guest: Be careful! Something's wrong with this house. Every night, I saw Jaden's eyes near the bed, in the dark corners, in the wall.

Guest: His face torn apart and smeared on the wall, his mouth mumbling about the murder on the farm.

Guest: That reminds me. You look just like poor Christine!!

Guest: *trembling* I-It's ok, Christine. Don't hurt me. I-I can introduce you to THEM, and THEY will bless you.

Guest: You can be one of us! You can be enlightened!

Tuesday: *sigh* You must be terrified by the nightmare.

Tuesday: Should I walk you around? Perhaps that'll make you better.

Guest: Don't! Stay away! Please—

Guest: I can share THEIR ritual with you. I'll keep the secret for you!

Guest: I-I remember ... Jaden recognized you here and disappeared shortly after.

Guest: A-And those rumors. It can't be a coincidence—your whole family being killed when you just "happened" to be out.

Tuesday: *sigh*

Tuesday: It's a crying shame that I didn't die with them.

Tuesday: Oh, I won't do anything to you now, but I can't make any promises about later.

Tuesday: So run, missy. Run away while you still can.

Step by step, Tuesday walks toward the quivering knife until its tip is pressed against her chest.

Guest: Ahh!

As fear overtakes her, she drops the knife and rushes down the stairs.

Tuesday sighs, bending over to pick it up.

Tuesday: This knife is far too blunt to hurt anyone.

She hears the front door open and slam shut. The footsteps fade into the fields outside.

Laughter echoes from the walls around her.

Tuesday: I didn't tell you the story so you could pull a prank on me.

Tuesday: Nor use them to drive away useful guests.

She feels the floor shaking as if a child is running on the ceiling downstairs.

Tuesday: Even if you scare all those cultists away, my mind won't change. So stop eating and killing them, okay? It's not funny.

Tuesday: And please, try making up a better story next time.

Tuesday: Alright, you can do whatever you want with this body. But this is the last time, understand?

Tuesday: There will be no next time.

A door slams shut behind her.

She ignores the motel's bad temper, putting the knife away and fixing her hem as if nothing has happened.

Then she steps over her own body.

Christine's Baby

COL-309817

???: And then? And then?

???: Did they make up? Did they make up?

???: What about the kid in the walls?

Tuesday: Oh, it's not in the walls. It's the motel itself.

Tuesday: Anyway, eventually we found a way to resolve the conflict between us.

Tuesday: It formally belonged to me.

Tuesday: And I decided to be its caretaker.

[English text unavailable]

COL-309818

Tuesday: I once found a notebook left by the previous owner.

Tuesday: She got lost—wandered in here thinking it was just a haunted house. Poor girl had nowhere to go, so she decided to stay.

Tuesday: *Do NOT enter doors that appear out of nowhere.*
Do NOT reply to the voices. They aren't real.
Do NOT answer late-night room service calls.

Tuesday: There are more "rules" like this. She wrote them all down, as if living in this motel was some kind of game.

Tuesday: Aww. Did she really believe that following these rules would keep her safe?

Tuesday nudges the body on the floor with her foot.

Sneering, scratchy sounds come from the walls.

Tuesday: Look at you, creating all these illusions as if you can predict my miserable fate.

Tuesday: That I'd fall to the floor, scratching my throat and gasping for breath.

Tuesday: *cough* Suffocated by an eyeball.

Tuesday: What did I see? What made me do this?

Tuesday: Ah. It must have been those blinking eyes outside, huh?

A ridiculous story, like those she once told to scare her friends.

[English text unavailable]

COL-309819

Tuesday: There are many doors in the hallway.

Footsteps pitter-patter behind her.

Tuesday: Nobody knows what's behind each of them.

Tuesday: Perhaps there's a butcher with a paper bag on his head or a chupacabra with dry, matted hair.

Tuesday: Or maybe there's a wandering ghost spying on the living through the keyhole.

Tuesday: There are no windows here, but the wind still blows.

Tuesday: I can hear voices in it. Someone's calling out.

Tuesday: "Christine." "Christine—"

Tuesday: Her parents are missing their child and her siblings are missing their older sister.

She steps into the shadows.

Tuesday: Poor child, so far from home.

Tuesday: Like a piece of flesh that's been torn from the body. She should be placed back in the wound.

Tuesday: Reunited with her family.

pound

A dull pounding sound comes from the wall beside her.

Tuesday: Or perhaps she should hide in the nearest room.

Tuesday: Just like this.

[English text unavailable]

COL-309820

Tuesday: Hmm, no. That's not it.

Tuesday: This room is far too small to hide in.

Tuesday: And my pursuer is everywhere.

pound

Tuesday: That's a loud one.

Tuesday: What should I do? Hide under the bed, or make a run for it?

Tuesday: Things won't end well if I stay here. Look!

She studies her own twisted face in the mirror.

Tuesday: I hope I'll never make that face.

Tuesday: Alright. Think, Tuesday.

Tuesday: Oh, maybe the bathroom's a safer place. The walls there are thicker. And it doesn't like water.

pound

The vase on the cupboard falls to the floor and shatters.

Tuesday: It's here, in this room with me.

Tuesday: Luckily, there's a public washroom outside. I'd better lead it there.

Tuesday: This disobedient child has to learn a lesson.

[English text unavailable]

COL-309821

Tuesday: But I have to get through this door first.

The doorknob won't turn.

No matter what she tries, it won't budge.

???: Haha ...

Laughter rings in the room.

Tuesday: Who shut the door?

She bends down to look through the keyhole.

Just as expected.

Tuesday: Maybe I didn't make myself clear.

Tuesday: Don't eat off the floor, and certainly don't spit them out again.

Tuesday: I'm getting pretty tired of you blocking doors with dead bodies.

She takes a few steps back and leans, preparing to ram the door open with her body.

Ready ...

Tuesday: My apologies, Mr. Jaden.

Tuesday: But curiosity killed the cat. Maybe you should quit staring through keyholes.

The destination is at the end of the hallway. All she has to do is run, and keep running.

[English text unavailable]

COL-309822

Tuesday: These walls are thick enough to hold it off.

Tuesday: But this door could be easily broken, and I don't have time to barricade it.

Tuesday: What else do we have here? A mirror ...

Tuesday: Everyone knows you shouldn't look into the mirror in a horror story.

How about shattering it?

She might be able to use a shard to defend herself. But she also might hurt herself in the process.

Then she recalls that handy little thing.

???: Haha ... Christine ...

She turns around to face the door.

Tuesday: This is the obvious weak point. It's most likely to break in through here.

Tuesday: Watch your feet and stand firm.

Tuesday: You don't want to fall like that vase. What a mess that would be.

Her heart pounds in her chest.

It's beating at a familiar pace—like when she looked down at the farm from the hill and saw the townsfolk panicking after another bloody murder.

Is this the thrill of escaping death?

No, it's more than that.

[English text unavailable]

COL-309823

Tuesday: The townsfolk were compelled by their curiosity, but even so, they didn't dare look at your bodies.

Tuesday: Daddy, Mama, my younger brother, and my dear little sister.

Tuesday: You've no idea how quickly people crumble in the face of fear.

She clings to the tool with her clammy hands.

It's a silver table knife. The kind that can bend easily.

It isn't threatening at all.

Throw it away. What can a blunt knife do?

Tuesday: Fear is a warning.

Tuesday: It protects us from danger.

Tuesday: Our fear of fire protects us from getting burned; our fear of heights stops us from falling.

Tuesday: Most of the time, fear comes from our imagination.

Tuesday: Countless unknowns and endless possibilities swim around in there.

Tuesday: What's hiding in the dark? What'll happen next? Whose footsteps are those echoing behind me?

Tuesday: When we don't have the courage to face it, fear overtakes us.

Tuesday: Fear is surrender.

Tuesday: Succumbing to fiction, to imagination.

She repeats the name. Christine.

Christine herself is a tiny silver knife. Thin, delicate, and quiet.

But sharper than anything.

Tuesday: And frightening others is defying your fear.

Tuesday: Oh, what a sweet moment. To defeat the undefeatable.

Tuesday: I forgive you.

Tuesday: Because you need me—a maid to tell you bedtime stories and a friend to spread fear.

Tuesday: You need a mother.

Tuesday: A mother to teach you, raise you, and also scold you when necessary.

Tuesday: A person who will teach you how to properly play with fear. Someone who will keep you from fire and water and all the rest of life's dangers.

Tuesday: I'm sure you've realized by now that your little tricks don't work on me.

She touches the floor and feels the beating pulse of the motel.

Tuesday: Fear comes from the unknown. So I need you to take a visible form.

Tuesday: Then I can keep my eye on you at all times. So ...

Tuesday: I wish you were small enough for me to cradle you in my arms.

A bundle of swaddling cloth appears on the floor in front of her.

She picks it up.

Tuesday: See? Fear isn't so scary.

Tuesday: Good child. Good.

The Shepherdess

COL-309824

Tuesday: Story time's over, children.

Tuesday: Close your eyes. I'm going to turn on the light.

Her little audience doesn't hesitate to give her all the praise and applause.

Followed by lots of questions. After all, children are very curious.

Before Tuesday can answer any of them, one voice cuts through the chatter.

TTT: Ugh, finally! I'm almost out of battery!

TTT: I hope this is our last story time.

While she's complaining, Poltergeist leans against her.

TTT: Um, excuse me? I'm not a wall, you know.

Poltergeist: Oh, Sorry! I'm sorry! I'm just a little scared.

TTT: ...!

Crackling noises fill TTT's screens.

Tuesday: Heh heh.

Tuesday: You seem to have something to say, little ones.

She smiles and looks at the huddling children.

La Source: I ...

La Source: It's a teeny-tiny bit scary.

Eagle: N-Next time I'm in a forest, I'll have to be on the lookout for those eyes!

Eagle: I will do my best to figure out what's going on!

Avgust: I don't understand. Will I go hungry if I live in the walls, too? I want to play with it. Do I have to go into the walls to play with it?

La Source: Maybe it doesn't need food, like us elfin.

La Source: Still, "not needing" and "not eating" are two different things!

La Source: I wouldn't say no to a slice of Ms. Bunny Bunny's apple pie.

Tuesday smiles. It seems the children's thoughts have already moved elsewhere.

Tuesday: Oh, I can make some desserts too.

Tuesday: Let's see, we have ... six children here.

Eagle: Six?

Twins Sleep: That's not right. That's not right.

Tuesday: Oh, that's right. Eight, including Ms. TTT, who came to play us a movie, and that girl under the sheet next to her.

Tuesday: Now, children. Why haven't you spoken to our new friend there, behind you?

La Source: Th-There's someone behind us?

La Source feels a kind of pressure coming from the back of the sofa.

Tuesday: Come on, join us.

Tuesday: Here, use this napkin to wipe your face.

Tuesday: Ah, look at you! There's blood all over your face.

Avgust: Should we take a look?

Eagle: On the count of three.

One ...

La Source: She's just trying to scare us.

Two ...

Twins Sleep: It's okay. It's okay.

Three!

They take a deep breath and turn around.

Barbara: Hello.

Barbara: I didn't want to interrupt you, so ...

The room falls silent. Barbara pushes through despite the awkward atmosphere.

Barbara: Hello, Tuesday. I brought you your dollhouse.

Tuesday: Thank you. Just put it on the table there.

Just as she puts it on the table, Barbara feels someone pulling at her jacket.

Barbara: ...?

La Source: Goodness me, you're a sheep!

La Source: Can we play together? I really like your fur. It's so curly and pretty.

The other children quickly surround this new friend.

Tuesday: Looks like they're getting along well. Good.

Tuesday: Didn't want to scare these lovely children off. That little bit of mystery was just right.

Tuesday: Alright, it's time you and I had a chat.

She walks over to the stack of TVs and knocks on the top one.

Tuesday: Where's that little girl who was with you just now?

TTT: She said there were too many people here and ran away. Maybe she's hiding somewhere.

TTT: Anyway, I helped you a lot this time!

TTT: I bet you really regret selling me now, huh?

TTT: Where else could you find such a useful, well-designed, and perfect-for-a-motel TV?

Tuesday: You're right. The other TVs I bought never worked properly. I rarely used them.

Tuesday: I couldn't have finished the story without you. Thank you.

TTT: Oh, it's fine. If you really want to thank me, how about you tell me some secrets?

TTT: I know you must have a load of them! Motels are one of the most juicy places for gossip—just like schools and restaurants!

Tuesday: I haven't heard anything yet about the motel you once stayed in.

Tuesday: But I do have something else to tell you.

Guest: Hmm, that TV seems like it could fetch quite a price.

It's a phone call about "TV business."

Guest: Alright, just sneak it out when no one's around.

Guest: It's said that there's a talking ghost living in it!

An eye is peering in through the keyhole.

Tuesday: Heh heh, she's no ghost.

She quietly gets to her feet, ensuring she doesn't make a sound.

Tuesday: What should I do now?

Tuesday: It's not proper to kick out a guest.

Tuesday: And it's not appropriate to keep a child at home forever, no matter how well-behaved she is.

Tuesday: Oh. Didn't a guest mention that there's a market nearby?

Tuesday: Yes. She said it was crowded—full of arcanist customers.

Tuesday: That might be a good choice.

TTT: So you sold me on purpose?!

Tuesday: Well, weren't you the one always saying the motel was too "dark and creepy"?

Tuesday: I thought it'd be better if I sold you to someone reliable—and the Foundation was just that.

Tuesday: It's thanks to them that we can talk face to face now.

TTT: Alright, I—

knock *knock*

TTT: Hmm? Someone's knocking at the door.

Tuesday: But the door isn't closed. See? The children left it open when they left.

TTT: What?

knock *knock*

TTT: I-I need to go.

TTT: Tell me more secrets next time, okay? Bye!

The TV screens turn off in an instant.

Tuesday: Hm. She's still so afraid of ghost stories. Just when I thought she was getting used to them ...

The dollhouse on the table shakes a little.

knock *knock*

The Double-Sided Mirror

COL-309825

Vertin: This should be the right time.

Vertin: Tuesday, are you there?

Again, there's no response.

Vertin: Am I too early? Or perhaps I'm late?

Vertin: Or maybe she didn't hear me.

She knocks one more time.

This time, her knock is answered.

Vertin: It took you 5 minutes and 23 seconds to open the door. Longer than I expected.

Vertin: Is there any reason for that?

Tuesday: Oh, I was catching up with an old friend. You really scared her with your knocking.

Tuesday: I was little preoccupied watching her reaction. My apologies.

Tuesday: How's your test going? Anything you'd like to share with me?

Vertin: With Ms. Barbara's help, we've managed to finish the mobility test.

Vertin: It seems the suitcase weakens the connection between the motel and the outside world.

Vertin: The dollhouse's structure and furnishings are an exact replica of the original motel.

Vertin: I can feel it shaking when Ms. Barbara moves, but not so much that I lose my balance.

Vertin: So, in conclusion, there's no need to take extra measures to restrain the dollhouse.

Vertin: Which I'm sure Ms. Vila will be glad to hear.

Tuesday: Wonderful! Then it's safe for those lively, curious children.

Tuesday: My child could use some friendly playmates.

Vertin: It's a win-win, then.

Tuesday: By the way, there's something I've been meaning to ask you.

Vertin: Yes?

Tuesday: It's about your suitcase. Is it a similar existence to my child?

Tuesday: Oh, you don't have to answer if you don't want to.

Tuesday studies her face, looking for any signs of hesitation.

Tuesday: Didn't you ever worry that I wouldn't open the door for you?

Tuesday: Anyway, I know we're going to spend a long time together, so I told it not to play any pranks on you.

Tuesday: But I didn't expect it to be so obedient.

The swaddling cloth in her arms stirs.

Tuesday: There, there. I'm not blaming you, sweetie.

Tuesday: Truth is, Ms. Vertin—I find you rather intriguing. You're so young, yet you're steady as a rock.

Tuesday: You're not afraid of separation or of being left alone. You don't seem to fear unknown dangers, either.

Tuesday: Even now, I don't see a hint of fear in you!

Her pale face blushes.

Like a silver knife reflecting the candlelight.

Tuesday: This is rare, indeed.

Tuesday: Are you really never afraid?

Vertin: ...

Is she never afraid?

Never is a strong word. It means not even once before, and not ever after.

Vertin: No.

Vertin: I've certainly had my fearful moments, and perhaps there'll be more to come.

Vertin: But I'm not afraid right now.

Vertin: As you said, fear comes from the unknown.

Vertin: And as we learn about the unknown, we conquer fear.

Vertin: You're welcome to stay here with us for more, if you're interested.

Tuesday: I see. You're confident. You must know yourself well.

Tuesday: Well, now that the story's come to an end, I wonder what people will do.

Tuesday: And I'm very much looking forward to seeing it.

What is fear?

Is it a sound without a source, an indescribable creature,
or a sword suspended by a single hair?

Is it a mirror?

Or a pair of eyes gazing into the abyss and the abyss staring back?

Tuesday: Whatever may come, I wish you all the best.